

B - Layouts

// Views

Background

EJS Layout Plugin

Another great feature of EJS is that it's extensible. That means third party developers can create plugins that extend it's base functionality.

One such plugin of great value is the EJS Layout Plugin. It allows for defining a default layout for our pages. The views will then be inserted into the body of the layout automatically, reducing code duplication.

In that way, we no longer have to copy and paste the HTML boilerplate code to every page of our website. Instead, we can focus on writing just the relevant bits of every one of our pages.

Install the plugin with the following command:

```
npm install express-ejs-layouts
```

Creating a Layout

Under our `views` folder we'll create a `layouts` folder with a new file: `main.ejs`.

The layout itself will contain any boilerplate code that is identical for every page:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<head>
  <title>Hellooo!</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet"
href="/static/styles.css">
</head>

<body>
  <div class="container">
    <%- body %>
  </div>
</body>

</html>
```

The only new thing here is the `<%- body %>` placeholder. This will cause any other view to be inserted into the placeholder before being rendered.

Using a Layout

Now we just need to tell EJS to use our layout:

```
const expressLayouts = require('express-ejs-
layouts');

app.use(expressLayouts);
app.set('layout', './layouts/main')
```

That's it!

Now if we ever need to add another stylesheet or JS library for instance, we won't have to go around and update every one of our views, just the main layout!

Description

Create a main layout for your facts server with a nice title and background. Your fact views should not only contain the contents of the body itself, without the `<html>`, etc.

To Submit

A zip file containing your code.

